

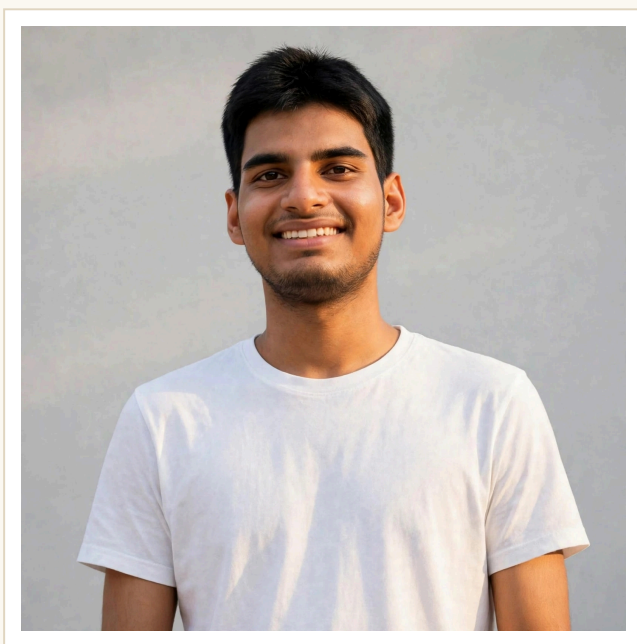
A BOY WHO NEVER THOUGHT

Safar Se Safar Tak

AN AUTOBIOGRAPHY

RAVI RAJ SINGH

A Boy Who Never Thought



Ravi Raj Singh
Patna, India · 2026



A Book by

A Boy Who Never Thought

Safar Se Safar Tak

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Ravi Raj Singh

Patna, India · 2026

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First written in 2024. Ongoing.

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To my parents, who gave me the courage to dream.

To my sisters, who taught me patience.

To the friends who stayed.



— Ravi Raj Singh

Author's Note

This book is not fiction. Every name, every date, every memory is real. I wrote it for my parents, my sisters, and for the boy I used to be.

Some memories are painful. Some are joyful. All of them are mine.

I have tried to be honest. I have tried to remember things exactly as they happened — though memory, like everything, fades with time.

If you find yourself in these pages, know that you mattered. You still do.

— Ravi Raj Singh

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How to Read This Book

This is a memoir — a true story of a boy growing up in Begusarai, Bihar. It covers the years 2008 to 2026, across eighteen chapters.

You can read it in order, or begin anywhere. Each chapter is a self-contained memory. The Hinglish edition is available alongside the English.

The story continues. It is still being written.



Begin anywhere. Read slowly.

This story belongs to you now.

CHAPTER ONE

Shuruaat

2008



2008, March. Bandwar. Raat ka waqt.

Hospital me doctor nahi tha. Isliye Seema aunty ke ghar le jana pada. Kisi ke ghar ki ek chhoti si room me, jahan ek nayi zindagi duniya me aane wali thi.

Female gynecologist thi. Wo Dadi ke paas aayi. Boli — "*Chachi, pota hua hai.*"

Angika me. Us tone me. Jaise gaon me khabar di jaati hai.

Dadi ne Papa ko phone kiya. Papa bahar the.

Woh kuch nahi bole.

Bas chup ho gaye.

Mummy kehti hain Papa ka chehra us raat alag tha. Nazariya alag tha. Shayad kuch soch rahe the. Shayad kuch samajh nahi paa rahe the. Ya shayad dono.

Par unhone mujhe god me liya.

Der se.

Pyaar se.

Mujhe ye sab yaad nahi. Main 11 mahine ka tha jab Dadi chali gayi. Aur main aaj tak ye nahi jaanta ki Dadi ne mujhe kabhi god me liya tha ya nahi. Ek sawaal jo hamesha dil me reh jayega — ek aisi aurat jisne meri khabar sabse pehle suni, kya usne mujhe kabhi chhua bhi tha?

Ye sab Mummy ne bataya. 2024 me. Jab main 10th me tha.

Tab tak main 16 saal ka tha. Aur mujhe apne janm ki kahani nahi pata thi.

Kyunki jab main paida hua — 6th din tak mera koi naam nahi tha.

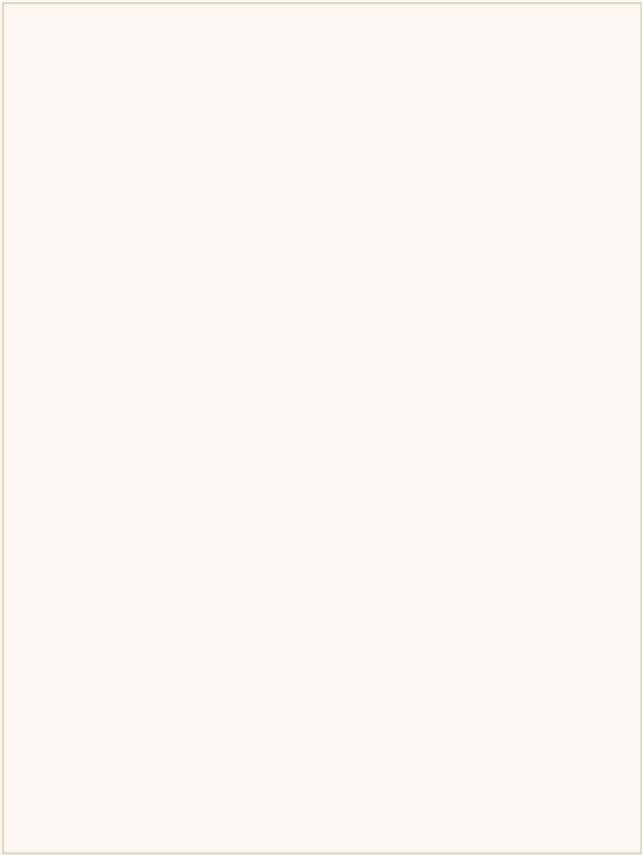


Fig. 1.1 – Bachpan ki tasveer, 2008

6th din, namkaran hua.

Pandit ji aaye. Baith gaye. Kundli dekhi. Phir bole — "N se naam rakhna subh rahega."
Nishant. Chinmay. Naman. Naam suggest hone lage.

Par Mummy chup thi.

Phir boli — "R se rakhna hai."

Pandit ji ne kaha N se. Mummy ne kaha R se.

Kyunki Mummy ka naam Rajani hai. Aur unhe laga — maa ke naam wale akshar se rakhna accha hota hai.

Koi nahi maana pehle. Log bole — "Nishant accha hai. Pandit ji ne bola hai."

Par Mummy nahi maani.

R se hi hoga.

Phir R se kaunsa naam? Ravi? Rahul? Raj? Rohit? Koi decide nahi hua.

Din aise hi nikal gaye.

Pandit ji "N" keh kar chale gaye. Mummy "R" pe atki rahi. Aur us beech, koi tha jo faisla nahi kar raha tha.

Log mujhe bulane lage.

Naam se nahi.

Ek pyaare se naam se.

Ghantee.

Mummy kehti hain — main bahut rota tha.

Raata-raat rota tha. Zor se. Koi chup nahi kara paata tha.

Ek raat, padosi bhaiya aaye. Ghar ke bahar se hi meri awaaz suni.

Andar aaye. Mujhe dekha. Phir bole —

"Arre, ye toh ghantee hai. Bajti rehti hai."

Sab hasne lage.

Mummy bhi.

Papa bhi.

Shayad main bhi rona bhool gaya us raat.

U ske baad, sab mujhe wahi bulane lage.

Mummy.

Papa.

Dadi.

Nani.

Padosi.

Gaon.

Sab.

Naam toh baad me aaya. Suraj. Ravi Raj. Par tab tak, sab mujhe Ghantee bulate the.

Mummy kehti hain — jab main bahut rota tha, toh wo mujhe darane ke liye bhooth banti thi.

"Bhooth aa gaya! Bhooth aa gaya!"

Aur main darr ke chup ho jaata tha.

Phir wahi Mummy, wahi bhooth, mujhe god me bitha ke doodh pilati thi.

Dar aur pyaar.

Ek hi aurat se.

Ek hi raat me.

Us raat ke baare me mujhe kuch yaad nahi.

Par Mummy soyi nahi thi.

Seema aunty so gayi thi. Papa bahar chup baithe the. Sirf Mummy jaag rahi thi — mujhe dekhti hui.

Bina naam ke bachche ko.

CHAPTER TWO

Ek Kami

2009



Papa ne bataya — 12 January 2009. Dopahar ka waqt.

Wo khet me the. Fasal ke beech. Din bhar ka kaam tha. Dhoop tez thi.

Tabhi koi daudta hua aaya.

Kya bola, ye Papa ne nahi bataya. Bas itna kaha — *"Koi daudta hua aaya, aur main bhaag ke ghar aaya."*

Khet se ghar tak ka raasta. Papa daudte aaye.

Pahunche.

Dadi ko dekha.

Angan me. Handpump ke paas. Wahi jagah jahan wo subah kaam karne gayi thi.

Us subah Dadi ne mujhe nahaya tha. Powder lagaya tha. Kajal lagaya tha. Khilona diya tha.

Aur phir kaam karne chali gayi thi — angan mein, handpump pe.

Papa ne kuch nahi kaha.

Bas chup ho gaye.

Wo chup rahe.

Bahut der tak.

Papa ne bataya — Dadi ko ambulance me Begusarai le jana pada.

Papa saath the. Nani bhi saath thi.

Nani — Mummy ki maa. Dadi ki samdhan. Do auratein jinka rishta sirf rishton ka tha, kabhi khaas baat nahi hui. Par us din, wo saath thi.

Begusarai ke doctor ne Dadi ko dekha. Phir Papa ko alag bulaya.

Kuch kaha.

Papa ne baad me ye nahi bataya ki doctor ne kya kaha. Bas itna — *"Doctor ne Patna refer kar diya."*

Par Papa ka chehra dekh ke Nani samajh gayi.

Last stage tha.

Ambulance phir chali. Patna ka raasta. Begusarai se Patna — 2 ghante. Par us din lamba tha.

Papa aur Nani chup the. Dadi beech me thi.

Koi kuch nahi bola.

Ambulance daud rahi thi. Par waqt nahi ruk raha tha.

Patna pahunchne se pehle — raaste me hi — Dadi chali gayi.

Pran chut gaya.

Muh se jhaag sa nikla. Safed.

Papa ne bataya.

Bas itna.

Uske baad unhone kuch nahi kaha.

Papa akele aaye.

Dadi ka shav leke. Nani udhar hi ruk gayi thi — nanighar chali gayi. Uska farz khatam ho gaya tha.

Ghar me sab ro rahe the.

Mummy.

Papa.

Behen.

Rishtedaar.

Sab.

Par main nahi ro raha tha.

Main 11 mahine ka tha.

Mujhe kuch pata nahi tha.

Main Dadi ke bagal me tha.

Sote hue.

Kisi ne mujhe wahan rakha tha. Ya main khud wahan tha. Mujhe nahi pata.

Us waqt kisi ne photo li.

Us photo me main Dadi ke bagal me so raha tha.

11 mahine ka.

Aur wo thandi thi.

Mujhe ye photo 2019 me mili.

Main 6th me tha. Ghar me kuch dhundh raha tha. Kisi album me wo photo mili.
Maine dekhi.

Kuch samajh nahi aaya.

Chup-chaap rakh di.

Aur phir 2024 me Mummy ne sab bataya.

Tab maine wo photo yaad ki.

Tab maine samjha —

us photo me main Dadi ke bagal me tha.

Aur Dadi us waqt thandi thi.

Main 11 mahine ka tha.

Mujhe kuch pata nahi tha.

CHAPTER THREE

Badalta Ghar

2010–2012



Din beeta jaa raha tha. Aur 2009 mein mummy ko bahut saari problems hui thi — dadi jee ki death ki wajah se.

Phir 2010. Mere liye kahun ya mere parivaar walo ke liye — accha raha hoga.

Us saal uncle ki shaadi thi. Ghar mein griha-pravesh tha. Aur bua jee¹ ka ladka bhi hua tha us saal.

In sab ke baad 2011 bhi aisa hi raha hoga kuch. Naye ghar mein aane ke baad hota hai na — purane ghar wale logon ke paas jaana, puja wagera mein. Toh mujhe sab log road par se hi bula liya karte the.

Aur main chupke se un logon ko dekha karta tha.

Is saal mera mundan² bhi hua tha — 4 May 2012 ko. Jisme main khush toh obviously nahi hi hounge. Kyunki mere pyaare baal chale gaye.

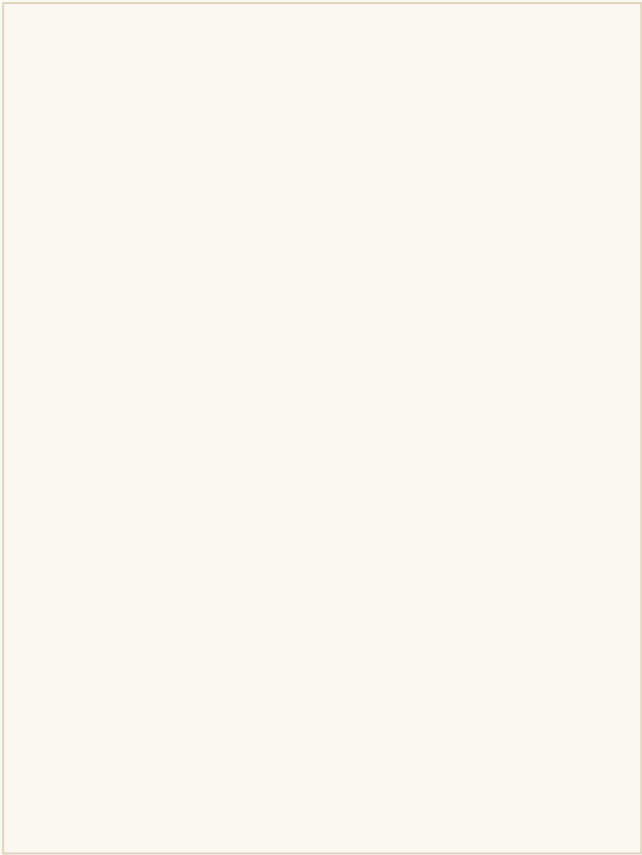


Fig. 3.1 – 4th birthday, 2012



Ghar ek jagah nahi, ek yaad hai.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

- ¹ Father's sister (aunt)
- ² Hindu ritual of first head-shaving

CHAPTER FOUR

School Ke Pehle Kadam

2013



Mundan ke photos ko dekhkar aisa lagta hai ki main apne 'hair' se bahut pyaar karta honga. Aur abhi bhi karta hu.

Waise 2012 mein hi shayad mera pehla b'day manaya gaya tha — March 2012 mein. Jaisa mummy ne bataya, jab main perhaps 4 saal ka ho gaya tha.

Wo kehte hai na — naye baal aane se mind growth hota hai. Toh mere mundan ke baad main aanganwadi¹, jo ki aunty ka school tha, usme jaane lag gaya tha. Jisme main soya bean count karke khata tha.

Ghar pe hi rehte, 'jhoola'² jhoolte — kab main Nursery ka syllabus kar le gaya, mujhe pata hi nahi.

"Jhula jhoolne ka shauk bachpan se hi."



Pehla kadam sabse mushkil, par sabse zaroori.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

¹ Government-run rural pre-school in India

² Swing

CHAPTER FIVE

Ghar Ka Batwara

2014-2016



To jaisa maine kaha — meri dono behen GBGS¹ school jaa rahi thi. Toh fees na kaafi kam (both together).

To, 2013 February — Saraswati Puja² ke din mera admission direct L.K.G³ (Lower Kindergarten) class mein ho gaya. Kyuki mere nursery ka course maine jhula jhoolke hi kar liya tha.

LKG.. Aarambh....

Name - Suraj Anand

School 1.0 : GAUTAM BUDDHA GLOBAL SCHOOL

Sanskar Nagar Bandwar Begusarai⁴

Motto :- "Tamaso Ma Jyotirgamaya"

To starting LKG mein bahut rota tha. Main apni behno ko bolta tha — lunch break mein mere se mil lene. Aur class ke end mein waha se gujarne.



Rishton mein diwaar aa jaaye, toh pyaar phir bhi rehta hai.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

¹ Gautam Buddha Global School, Begusarai

² Festival of Goddess Saraswati

³ Lower Kindergarten

⁴ A city in Bihar, India

CHAPTER SIX

Ek Anokha Kadam

2017



Samay badhta gaya. Aur main bahut hi below avg student tha.

Top karta toh tha — but niche se. (Down se.)

Dost banne toh honge us time. But mujhe yaad nahi. Lekin jo bhi ho — bachpan badhiya raha mera.

Main:

2014 - UKG

2015 - 1st class

1st class mein 2015 mein tha. Tab mummy "Don Bosco Academy"¹ mein padhane jaati thi. Subah se shaam lag jaate the.

Financial constraint ke karan main apni mummy ke saath 'Don Bosco Academy'² (Cheria Bariyarpur, Begusarai³) Branch mein jaane laga. Kyuki free tha mera waha.

Main 3 month hi gaya waha. Kyuki safar mein bore ho jaati thi. Ghar toh aane jaane mein hi lag jaate the.

But in search of income (Ghar chalane ke liye), Mummy ne continue rakkha.

Us time hamare ghar mein dispute hue. Aur division ho gaya — land, saaman sab ka...

Though hamara ghar bahut bada hai. Aur pehle se hi 2 sided ghar thaa. Toh koi problem nahi hui.

Pehle main left side rehta tha. Fir main right side rehne laga.

But abhi bhi financial conditions bigadti jaa rahi thi.

2016 mein maine phir se, 3 month baad, phir se GBGS⁴ mein continue kiya.

2016 mein 1st Class ke term-2 exam maine nahi diya. Kyuki mera tabiyat bigad gaya tha. Aur main unhealthy tha.

'8 saal ka ladka'

Kaafi dost the us time: Abhilash, Ayush, Harsh Raj



Zindagi jab mod deti hai, tab tum aage badhte ho.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



NOTES

- ¹ A Catholic school in India
- ² A Catholic school in India
- ³ A city in Bihar, India
- ⁴ Gautam Buddha Global School, Begusarai

CHAPTER SEVEN

Ek Nayi Pehchaan

2017



3rd Class mein mere 8 seniors mere dost banne lag gaye. Aur ab se 'Suraj Bhaiya' keh ke bulate hain mujhe.

To 3rd Class mein, jab main smooth way jaa raha tha — tab Nakib, Abhinav aage se jab junior ho gaye. Tab Rohit, Satyam bhi aage se jab ban gaye the...

Ladgayi hamare class mein. Random ladai.

To ladko ke koi value hi nahi thi class mein.

And, Teacher ne mujhe dant lagayi. Aur Shitanshu ne bhi. And rank kharab ho gayi. Aur Ganesh School chala gaya.

To 3rd Class se 4th Class (State Board) ke naam pe Chandan Sir ki wajah se, sab log badal gaye. Aur unhone state capitals ke naam yaad karwa diye the.

Yaad hai kuch kuch, toh yahi likh raha hoon. Due to lack of teachers in school.

Science us time padhati thi Veena Ma'am — living things wagherah ke baare mein. Hindi → Sadhana Ma'am. English → Ekta Miss. Sanskrit bhi → Sadhana Ma'am hi padha deti thi. 3rd Class smoothly gaya.



Izzat chup chaap kamai jaati hai, bolke nahi milti.

— RAVI RAJ SINGH



CHAPTER EIGHT

Uthne Ki Chah

2018



4th Class mein maine socha hoga — ki meri rank kyun aa rahe? Tab padhayi start ki — Chanchal Sir se.

Coaching lagwayi Mummy ne. Lekin mera rone ka superpower bahut accha tha. Jab bhi mujhe koi kaam karne ka mann nahi karta, toh main rone lagta tha.

Teachers (2018):

Gautam Sir — English

Sunil Sir — Math

Gautam Sir / Amrender Sir — SST

Mohit Sir — English

Bittu Sir — Computer

Manish Sir — Processing

4th Class ka result aa gaya. Us time meri rank aayi 4th.

Maine 4th kiya tha. Aur literally mujhe bura laga us din.

Maine baith ke soch raha tha — ki agar 5th Class mein 1st kiya, toh 5th mein 1st rank aayegi.

1st: Swati**2nd:** Sanjana**3rd:** Asmita**4th:** Suraj Anand (A.K.A Ravi Raj)

Maine socha — fir dusron ke peeche nahi karna hai. Khud ko itna aage karna hai, dusre peeche ho jaye.

Holi¹ wagherah mein maje aate the. Gaane ke liye playground mein jaate — toh kone mein baith ke suna karte the. Lekin dost baithne nahi dete the...



Rank sirf number hai — uthne ki chah ki koi hadd nahi.



CHAPTER NINE

Sapna Sakar Hota Hai

2018–2019



Meri Mummy ne 2018 mein hi GBGS¹ join kar liya tha. Tab se wo is school mein Hindi padhaya karti thi.

Samay beeta ja raha tha. Aur exams hote rahe...

Hamare school mein "Sakhi" acchi thi. Matlab current affairs wagherah sabke bahut the...

Wo school toh halaki 8th tak tha. Lekin usne 6th-7th tak hi bachhe padh paate the. Kyunki uske baad school chhod dete the — kyunki teachers nahi the.

To us hisaab se, hum log jo (5th mein) the — wo senior hue na. To hum 4 dost jaate the assembly karne.

Aur girls group + 4-5 aur girls karti thi assembly mein.

To commanding karne mein bhi hamari ladai ho jaati thi — "main karunga", "nahi main"...
Bla Bla Bla.

Saare function mein bas pehli baar participate bhi 5th Class mein hi kiya maine...

Aur us time jo mera engineer banne ka sapna tha — mera wo sapna tha pura toh ho hi jayega.

Ye pehli baar tha jab maine 15 August 2018 ko dance mein participate kiya. Aur speech bhi diya.

Mere uncle (Director Sir) ne mujhe Pen gift kiya. Aur assembly mein har ek bachhon se poocha: "Bade hoke kya banoge?"

Kisi ne Doctor kaha. Toh kisi ne Police, Army, Astronaut, Scientist...

Par main — Suraj Anand (Ravi Raj) — yahan gaya aur kaha "Engineer" bola.

Toh Sir ne poocha: "Bridge wala ya Computer wala?"

To main chup reh gaya. Kyunki mujhe pata nahi tha ki engineer hone ke liye kya karna hota hai!



Sapne chillate nahi — dheere se sakar hote hain.



CHAPTER TEN

Ek Shraddhanjali aur Alvida

2019



Mujhe bas engineer banna tha kyunki mere Mummy ji¹ engineer the.

To khair, March 2019, mera 5th Class ka exam hua. Aam usse pehle hi 10 Feb 2019 (Saraswati Puja²) ke din kuch khaas hua.

Uske beech mein Nov 2018 mein hi EC Competition (Clean & Green School) exam hua 14th ko (Don Bosco).

Tha toh pehli baar main ghar se school ke bachhon ke saath gaya — doston ke saath maza aaya.

Jab result aaya, toh pehli baar competition ka realisation hua. Mera cutoff (85/100) aaya tha.

Sirf 51 bachhe select hue. Aur highest marks 96 tha.

Shaam ko management ne hume logon ko bulaya aur award diya sabko. Certificate, medal, aur GK Award.

Khushi is baat ki hui ki pehli baar gift aur itna respect mila. Aur bura is baat ka laga ki competition L.K.G. ke toh kaise karunga compete.

Halaki, 14 Feb 2019 ko Pulwama attack³ bhi hua tha. Aur usi din prize distribution tha.

Toh tribute diya CRPF⁴ Indian Forces ko. Aur wapas karke aa gaya main.

Class 5th ke final exam ICSE⁵ pattern ke the. Result aana tha last week of March, jo ki 31/03/2019 ko tha.

First day of the Class mein 85%+ second position Sushil ko tha. Jo mera competitor thi.

Mera mood change ho gaya tha. Aur main diligent (mehnati) bhi ban gaya.

Meri Mummy ne hamesha mere baare mein achha socha. Aur jab unko pata chala ki main 5th Class mein pass ho gaya, toh unki khushi ka koi thikana nahi tha.

Fir school shift kar chuka tha, toh sab se dosti ho gayi. 80% se zyada marks laane wale bacche bahut kam the.

Jab humare 8 mates ki group ki baat chali — toh sabne school chhod diya. Sab bichad gaye. Sab log apne aap ko sambhalne lage.

Jo hone tha, wo hone laga...



NOTES

- ¹ 'Ji' is a suffix of respect — Smt. Rajani Kumari
- ² Festival of Goddess Saraswati
- ³ Feb 14, 2019 — Kashmir terror attack
- ⁴ Central Reserve Police Force — India's largest paramilitary force
- ⁵ Indian Certificate of Secondary Education

CHAPTER ELEVEN

Process of Shifting

2019



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER TWELVE

Chapter Twelve

2020



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Chapter Thirteen

2021



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Chapter Fourteen

2022



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

Chapter Fifteen

2023



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

Chapter Sixteen

2024



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

Chapter Seventeen

2025



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

Chapter Eighteen

2026



Ye chapter abhi likha ja raha hai. Jald aa raha hai.

The Story Behind the Story

I didn't plan to write a book. I started writing — one memory at a time. One evening. One cup of chai.

It began as a diary. Then it became a way to understand myself.

I wrote about my childhood because I wanted to remember it. I wrote about my struggles because I wanted to survive them. And I wrote about my dreams because I still believe in them.

This book is not the end. It is the beginning of a longer conversation — with myself, and with you.

— Ravi Raj Singh

About the Author



Ravi Raj Singh

AUTHOR

Ravi Raj Singh is a writer based in Patna, India. He has kept a personal diary since childhood, and began writing online around 2023–24.

"A Boy Who Never Thought" is his first book. It grew out of that habit. The book is written in both English and Hinglish, and remains in progress.

His writing focuses on ordinary lives, small moments, and the quiet ways a person grows.



Written in Patna, India

2026



Set in Playfair Display & Lora

Typeset by hand

No frameworks

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*An 18-year journey from 2008 to 2026.
From Bandwar, Begusarai to the dream
of becoming an Engineer.*

*A true story of loss, changing homes, first steps
into school, and the will to rise.*



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Ravi Raj Singh is a self-taught learner and aspiring engineer from Patna, India.

This memoir recounts the journey of resilience, loss, and determination against all odds.



SCAN TO READ